



## MONTHLY UPDATE

# Standards: monthly update, August – September 2026

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35 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.

ANGOLA · BENIN · CAPE VERDE · CENTRAL AFRICAN REPUBLIC · CHAD · COMOROS · COTE D'IVOIRE · DR CONGO · EGYPT · EQUATORIAL GUINEA · ESWATINI · ETHIOPIA · GABON · GAMBIA · GUINEA · KENYA · LIBYA · MALAWI · MALI · MAURITANIA · MAURITIUS · MOZAMBIQUE · NIGER · NIGERIA · RWANDA · SAO TOME AND PRINCIPE · SENEGAL · SEYCHELLES · SOMALIA · SOUTH AFRICA · SUDAN · TANZANIA · TOGO · UGANDA · ZAMBIA

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

## Angola

The standards estate entered the record this month rather than moving in it. The national quality-infrastructure institute, formed by the 2021 merger of the standardisation and accreditation bodies, is [an ISO correspondent member](#) — a category that carries no vote on ISO technical work — and in March [published its 2026 national standards catalogue, incorporating 140 new standards](#), among them texts arising from SADC regional harmonisation across the circular economy, construction and building materials, food, quality management, safety rules, technology suppliers, occupational health and safety and vehicle safety. The institute states that Angolan standards are voluntary and are made mandatory only by legislation in the public interest, which is where a reader has to look for their force.

## Benin

Benin's standards body is now inside the international system rather than beside it: the Agence Nationale de Normalisation [is recorded as a full member of ISO](#), having [launched the national NB conformity mark in April](#). Membership is a standing on paper; what the base does not hold is a standards catalogue, a certified-product count, or any ICT-specific Beninese standard.

## Cape Verde

The Prime Minister told Parliament during the State of the Nation debate on 31 July 2026 that the statistics institute had produced falsified data, and announced an independent evaluation to establish alleged interference and manipulation. On 3 August the institute's board rejected the allegations clearly, firmly and categorically, and said it was available to receive any external evaluation mission or peer review, undertaking to supply all technical documentation ([both accounts](#)). Nothing is established about the evaluation's terms of reference, who conducts it, when it reports, or whether its findings will be published. The dispute is not new — anonymous technicians raised it in August 2025 and the institute rejected it in September 2025 — and the two accounts remain unreconciled.

## Central African Republic

Enforcement of the satellite-access rule moved from communiqué to the street. On 12 August the regulator [began a control operation across Bangui – Damala, Benz-Vi and Miskine, and the Don Bosco and Marabéna roundabouts – to identify internet-access points absent from its own registers](#), on the digital economy minister's instruction. The ministry's estimate is [about 3,000 Starlink users in the country against 200 registered with the regulator](#), and the operation is to extend progressively to provincial cities.

Two of the operators visited said they had not been told registration was required and undertook to regularise. No register total is published, so the ratio stands on the ministry's own account.

## Chad

The standards agency published its first adoptions: [the quality management systems committee adopted ten international standards as draft Chadian norms on 5 August 2026, with sessions of the electrotechnical and petroleum products committees either side of it](#). It is the first movement the base holds against a mandate standing since 2014.

## Comoros

The government's own concept note for a single citizen portal [names an interoperability framework and a government enterprise architecture as components of the Plan National e-Gouv](#). It is the first record in the base of either, and neither document is published: what the note asks for is a census of the e-government platforms ministries have already built. The page carries no date and is dated by the day it was retrieved.

## Cote d'Ivoire

Migration data was the month's standards work, and it is regional. Two workshops [ran at Abidjan from 18 to 22 August on harmonising migration and macroeconomic data across the regional bloc](#). A national migration data governance strategy [was named by the diaspora directorate at a profiling workshop](#), but no text, timetable or adopting instrument is held for it.

## DR Congo

The telecoms regulator [installed equipment giving it near-real-time access to mobile operators' own data](#) on service quality, traffic flows and spectrum, which the ministry says will let it establish breaches objectively rather than on operators' own reporting. No first enforcement action or published measurement has followed.

## Egypt

Transfer-pricing guidance [has not been revised since 2018](#), and appeal committees relying on the statutory provision requiring a minister-approved guide have cancelled some penalties. The account is a named practitioner's, not the tax authority's.

## Equatorial Guinea

A quality-of-service regulation of 2018 is [confirmed in force on the regulator's own legislation index](#). Only its title and date are held, not its text; the same index lists an inspection and sanctions regulation of 2020 and a broadband-market update of February 2026, neither of which the ledger carries as a row.

## Eswatini

Asked on 4 August how online publications comply with the data-protection law, the ICT ministry [answered that implementation, enforcement and oversight do not fall within its direct mandate](#) but are vested in ESCCOM.

## Ethiopia

A standing readiness instrument the base had not held was named from practice rather than from the regulator. A practitioner's case is that a [central bank microfinance directive of 2022 already defines the governance, risk-management and operational readiness that institutions skip when they buy digital wallets before building the capability to run them](#). The directive text is not held and no supervisory finding, enforcement action or compliance count is published, so what the base has is the rule's existence and one account of how it is being ignored.

## Gabon

Service quality is the one obligation the base cannot show being enforced. Reporting of 25 August 2026 states that at a departmental capital, a commune since 1996 with a prefecture, town hall and schools, [the incumbent sells data bundles on a network whose coverage appears and disappears while prepaid credit and bundle validity run down normally, and puts the regulator's inaction to the president of its regulatory council](#). No quality-of-service determination, decision or sanction is published, which is why the row stands here as *Not held*.

## Gambia

The standards bureau's position was restated from both ends this month. Its director general put adoptions at [around 500 standards, alongside membership of the African standards organisation](#), while the international body's own profile records the bureau as a [Correspondent member without a vote at the standards and electrotechnical organisations, and the country's technical-barriers enquiry point](#). A correspondent member may adopt standards; it does not help make them.

## Guinea

The committee meant to make the state's own financial data consistent [sat again on 6 August, three years after it was created to align the accounts with the 2014 international manual](#). It produces a regular statement of state financial operations and, on the finance ministry's own account, still faces inconsistent data across the Treasury, the central bank and other agencies.

## Kenya

Two days after introducing the equipment distributor licence, the Communications Authority introduced vendor class-licence rules requiring a twelve-month warranty and three years of retained sales records. The data-protection regulator launched a quality management system on 14 July, phased toward external certification.

Two sets of standards arrived, one binding and one draft. The revenue allocation commission [gazetted binding standards for county own-source revenue automation, covering the system lifecycle from procurement to audit and requiring data ownership and portability safeguards to cut vendor lock-in](#); no compliance date, county baseline or enforcement mechanism accompanies them. The pharmacy regulator [published draft guidelines for digital pharmacy services covering telepharmacy, electronic prescribing and digital health records](#), with no consultation close or adoption date stated. The text is a [second revision that widens the scope of regulation from internet pharmacy](#)

services to digital pharmacy services generally, reaching digital health platforms, pharmacy chains and third-party technology, hosting, payment and logistics providers, and carrying a 2026 effective date against a 2029 review; its approval blocks are unsigned.

## Libya

On 2 August the Municipal Guard's Investigation and Information Gathering Office, acting on Central Bank instructions and with the Ministry of Economy and Trade, [said any surcharge on card payment is prohibited](#) and that the displayed price is the final price. [Complaints had reported spreads reaching 20% in some clinics and medical centres.](#)

The committee behind the national information system spent its sixth meeting fixing its own composition. Meeting in Tripoli on 1 September it [reviewed financial indicators and settled its membership rules, tying permanent seats to the office of director of an information and documentation centre and requiring a written letter for a proxy.](#) Its mandate, its published output and the indicators it reviewed are not held — what is established is that it meets, and now who sits on it.

## Malawi

On 3 August the copyright society's blank media levy distribution was reported to rest on records submitted by licensed disc-burning centres rather than on digital consumption, with a proposal to key distribution to digital consumption voted down at an annual general meeting.

## Mali

The standards agency's own budget is the month's clearest measure of it. Its fourteenth ordinary board session [balanced a 2026 budget of CFA 243,306,303 against CFA 318,369,036 in 2025, a fall of about a quarter,](#) and it [holds a correspondent member profile with the international standards organisation.](#) The agency was created by ordinance in March 2012; no standard adopted, certification issued or staffing figure is published, so what is measurable about it is the money.

## Mauritania

The state asked for outside help with the numbers behind its own borrowing. The finance minister [received an International Monetary Fund technical assistance mission on public finance statistics and state-owned enterprise debt, working on compilation in line with the 2014 government finance statistics manual and reviewing progress on the collection, reliability and consolidation of state-enterprise financial data.](#) No baseline, target or publication commitment is stated for that data, so what is currently held about state-enterprise debt stays unknown.

## Mauritius

Mauritius moved to bind its own digital services to a standard. Cabinet [took note on 28 August of a Digital Service Framework setting mandatory principles and standards for every government digital service, from procurement through maintenance,](#) and the government information service [set out that the framework will cover every service developed, procured or maintained by the state.](#) Noted is not issued: the record held carries no compliance date, no owner and no consequence for a service that fails it.

## Mozambique

The regulator opened a free public device-identity lookup on 4 August, checked against a registry held by an industry association ([regulator notice](#)). The notice sets out no type approval, import control, blocking regime or penalty.

## Niger

The regulator's quality-of-service thresholds are not held. Its 2021 annual report [names the decision that sets them and what it does, but not its threshold values](#), and the regulator's own site does not surface the 2026 formal notices either. The standard the operators are being measured against cannot be read off the record, and neither, therefore, can the finding that they failed it.

## Nigeria

The clearance gate over federal IT spending was quantified for the first time. The technology development agency's director-general told a bar association conference that it [reviewed 1,092 project proposals from 326 ministries, departments and agencies between July 2023 and July 2026, worth more than N4.24 trillion, and cleared 1,056 of them worth N3.84 trillion](#) — about N400bn and 36 proposals not cleared, on criteria and for reasons that are not published. He urged a Nigeria First approach in procurement so that public spending creates market for indigenous suppliers.

The standards move of the month is aimed at the innovation estate rather than at government systems. A draft [National Innovation Hub Standards Framework went to an Abuja validation exercise, giving hubs a self-assessment tool across seven dimensions and about 35 categories and a defined maturity pathway](#), against a count of more than 339 hubs heavily concentrated in Lagos and Abuja — the stated purpose being to make a hub in a state outside those two legible enough to be funded without its founders relocating. At the same workshop the [EU delegation put Team Europe support for the country's digital sector at more than €820m between 2021 and 2027](#). It is a draft at validation, so what the framework will require of a hub, and who will assess it, is not yet settled.

## Rwanda

The [government-wide enterprise architecture framework, version 2.1, is in force to govern ICT architecture standards](#) and is now held in excerpt. It is distinct from the interoperability framework named in earlier academic work, for which the base still holds no separate instrument.

## Sao Tome and Principe

[BGF Bank Sao Tome became the first bank in the country certified to ISO 9001:2015](#), the certificate presented at a ceremony marking 55 years of its group in the presence of members of the government, the central bank and the diplomatic corps. The national quality body, an autonomous institute under the finance ministry, is [the country's correspondent member of the international standards organisation](#) - the membership category for states without a fully developed national standards activity. A single private certification is the whole of the month's adoption record, and no public body is recorded as certified to any international standard.

## Senegal

Senegal adopted [non-binding Francophone West African AI governance guidelines on 6 July](#).

Senegal held its [first national green-coding and responsible-digital workshop](#), bringing about 170 people from the sector to Dakar on 18 and 19 August 2026 to set the basis for a national approach to digital sobriety. Nothing was adopted at it.

## Seychelles

The department that would write government-wide standards restated its mandate rather than exercising it. Its own Policy, Standards and Research Section [claims adopted technical standards for the seamless interoperability of e-government services, and the integration of every e-government application and database through established software and database standards](#). None of those standards is published, so the claim can be dated and not checked.

## Somalia

The auditor general's office and a partner supreme audit institution [completed the third phase of a cooperation programme on auditing government information systems](#). No audit report, scope or next-phase date has been published.

## South Africa

Parliament's communications committee [prefers strengthening the existing regulators through the ICT and media regulators forum to creating the four artificial-intelligence bodies the withdrawn draft policy proposed](#). The forum was launched in 2024 and no instrument establishing its powers is held.

## Sudan

Two standing accounts entered the record and no standard was made. The national standards body publishes [a catalogue of adopted Sudanese Standards against their international equivalents](#), under the Standards Act of 2008; it is a cross-sector list rather than an information-technology one. The digital transformation ministry's own product page for its government-institution platform [names interoperability among the platform's design principles](#) and lists the government institutions already integrated onto it. A catalogue of product standards and a platform that integrates ministries are not the same thing as a published interoperability framework other systems can be built against, and no such framework is held.

## Tanzania

The window's only standards movement is a visit. The communications regulator [undertook a two-day benchmarking visit to its Kenyan counterpart to exchange experience and practice in regulating satellite communications](#). Nothing was signed and nothing issued: it is carried because the base holds no other statement of how this regulator approaches satellite licensing, and it will settle or lapse on whether anything follows.

## Togo

Togo launched the National Accounting Council, [the body a regional directive of 28 November 1997 requires each member state to establish](#). The directive itself is now held. Twenty-nine years between obligation and institution is the finding.

The standards machinery came into view too: the [national standards agency is a full member body](#) of the international standards organisation; under the food-system resilience programme it drew up [46 national standards and the accreditation committee 31 certification programmes](#) in August — drawn up and disseminated, the ministry says, not homologated.

## Uganda

The sector agreed to count itself consistently. The technology ministry [will standardise information and communication technology indicators and definitions with NITA-U and the Uganda Bureau of Statistics](#). Agreeing what an indicator means is the precondition for any of the sector's published figures being comparable year to year; the record held carries no date by which the standardised set is to be in use.

## Zambia

The standards bureau states its own position rather than reporting a change. Its service page [puts more than 50 international standards adopted as Zambian Standards, within a catalogue of more than 6,500 national standards across sectors including information and communication technology](#). The page carries no date, so the figures are dated to retrieval, and no breakdown by sector or year of adoption is published — an adoption count with no series behind it.

The trust layer under the interoperability standards was stood up. The communications regulator [operationalised the National Digital Trust Anchor in its capacity as national root certification authority, the framework issuing and verifying digital certificates and signatures establishing the identity of people and organisations, on the legal base of the electronic communications and transactions statute](#). No certificate count, subordinate-authority list, accreditation route or fee schedule is published, and the launch reaches the base through a news report rather than the regulator's own notice — which for a root certification authority is the one thing a relying party would want to be able to check. The [national public key infrastructure was launched with a named security vendor](#), its master cryptographic keys generated under independently audited conditions, held offline and split among multiple custodians so that no single entity has unilateral control.

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## ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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